Michael Brackin

Chicago, IL | mbrackina@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/michael-brackin | awesomeparcore.github.io

EXPERIENCE

Service Desk | **Jewel-Osco**, Chicago, IL **August 2023 – Present**

- Ran the service desk alone for a 6-hour shift, handling every customer and transaction without backup, then completed all closing operations, from reconciling cash drawers to restocking the desk.
- Supervise service desk employees during shifts, assigning tasks and making sure customers are covered.
- Train and mentor new team members on desk procedures and point-of-sale operations.
- Resolve customer issues and complaints, working through problems until they are settled.
- Process payments, returns, and exchanges accurately on the point-of-sale system.

PROJECTS

J.A.R.V.I.S. Voice Assistant | Python, Ollama, Whisper, Claude API, Spotify API, Cloudflare Workers **In Progress**

- Built a voice-activated Windows desktop assistant in Python that responds to a wake phrase and handles 10 types of requests, including finding files, launching apps, arranging windows, web search, calendar events, and reminders.
- Designed a privacy-first speech pipeline that runs fully on-device (openWakeWord, Whisper, Piper, and a local Qwen3 8B model through Ollama), with an option to switch to the Claude API.
- Integrated the Spotify Web API through OAuth for music control, and built a Discord bot on Cloudflare Workers (JavaScript) that delivers reminders even while the PC is off.
- Shipped an auto-updater that installs new releases from GitHub, screen analysis with a local vision model, and 4 themes that each change the name, wake phrase, personality, voice, and look.

Reinforcement Learning on FrozenLake | Python, PyTorch, Stable-Baselines3, Gymnasium

- Built a Deep Q-Network from scratch in PyTorch and compared it with Stable-Baselines3's PPO on the slippery FrozenLake environment in Gymnasium.
- Both agents reached the 74.2% best-possible success rate, while PPO trained in 2 minutes versus 22 for the DQN, an 11x speedup.

Radial Karambit Illustration | Illustration Final Project, Adobe Illustrator

- Conceived and designed a self-directed final project: a radial composition of 10 karambit knives arranged in a pinwheel so every blade spirals into a single center point.
- Gave each blade its own color scheme built from layered tonal bands, keeping grip and ring detail consistent across all 10 forms, and delivered it as a print-ready 11" x 8.5" piece.

EDUCATION

Dominican University, River Forest, IL **Expected May 2027**

Major: Computer Science | Minor: Graphic Design

Relevant Coursework: Data Structures, Algorithm Analysis and Design, Operating Systems, Database Design and Programming, Artificial Intelligence, Front-End Web Development, Back-End Web Development, Windows-Based Application Development

LANGUAGES & TECHNOLOGIES

Languages: Java, Python, C#, JavaScript, SQL, HTML, CSS

Tools: Visual Studio 2022, Visual Studio Code, Eclipse, Google Colab, Ollama, GitHub, FileZilla

Libraries: PyTorch, Stable-Baselines3, Gymnasium

Design: Adobe Photoshop, Illustrator, InDesign